

Week 01 Glossary

Term	Definition
Entity	A thing of interest that the system stores data about.
Attribute	A property that describes an entity.
Relationship	An association between two entities.
Database	An organised collection of related data.
DBMS	Software used to create and manage databases.
RDBMS	A DBMS based on the relational model using tables and keys.
Primary Key (PK)	An attribute that uniquely identifies a record.
Foreign Key (FK)	An attribute that links one table to another.
Constraint	A rule that the data must follow.
Cardinality	The number of relationships between entities.
Optionality	Whether participation in a relationship is mandatory or optional.
Schema	The structure/design of the database.
Normalisation	The process of reducing redundancy and improving data integrity.
Integrity	Ensuring data is accurate and consistent.
ER Diagram (ERD)	A visual model of entities and relationships.
Conceptual Schema	The high-level logical design of the database.
Relational Model	A database model based on tables (relations).
Data Independence	The ability to change one level of the database without affecting another.
Metadata	Data about the database structure and definitions.
Table	A collection of related records organised into rows and columns.